

Microsoft Office 2003

Almost all of us use Microsoft Office. The suite is so well-designed, comprehensive and robust that it has become the *de facto* office applications suite in most offices and homes.

Indeed, the components of the suite have each become the standard in the area of productivity they offer. For example, MS Word is today *the* word processor of choice in most offices.

MS Office has a long history, and Office 2003 is the latest installment. There are significant improvements over previous versions, and in this book, we talk exclusively about this edition of Office. Note, however, that several features, menus and procedures are similar to those of Office XP, also known as Office 2002, so if you're using Office XP, you will be able to use most of the information that this book provides.

The book is organised, very naturally, according to the components of the suite. There's an introductory chapter about Office-wide features and what you need to know about the differences in the 2003 edition. The chapters that follow address the individual components: Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook and Access.

We have covered Access, which not too many of you may be using. Our objective in covering Access has been to present the idea that Access need not be as intimidating as it seems at first glance, and that you can easily learn to use and take advantage of this powerful database application.

Help in the components of Office is so comprehensive, and the applications themselves so intuitive, that it's easy for anyone to use the suite without training. However, a little reading up on the features that Office provides will go a long way in increasing your productivity. It has, therefore, been our objective in this book to help you go a little deeper into Office, so you can take full advantage of the features it provides.